

DESERT NOMADS

DESERT NOMADS IS A 5E NPC SUPPLEMENT THAT PRESENTS A FULLY REALIZED DESERT TRADE CONFEDERATION BUILT around mobility, social power, and environmental mastery rather than military conquest. Instead of treating desert cultures as raiders or generic bandits, this book focuses on caravan networks, shield-bearing guards, camel riders, traders, and divine leaders whose authority is rooted in survival, negotiation, and communal defense.

The intent of this product is mechanical cohesion and encounter-driven design without escalation into army-scale warfare. These nomads rely on layered cloth garments rather than armor, large round shields rather than heavy plating, and divine guidance rather than arcane spellcraft. Sand and heat are integrated directly into their mechanics—ignoring difficult terrain, shaping vision with blowing dust, resisting fire beneath desert sun, and invoking divine intervention to locate hidden water sources.

These NPCs are built to support a wide range of desert encounters: caravan negotiations, oasis diplomacy, trade disputes, escort missions, defensive shield formations, mounted skirmishes, and survival-driven expeditions. Combat exists, but it is secondary to social leverage and environmental control. Cultural details, faith, and political structure are intentionally minimal. Whether these nomads are honorable traders, pragmatic deal-makers, guarded isolationists, or regional power brokers is left to the GM. Use these stat blocks as tools. How and why the desert shapes them is yours to decide.

DESERT NOMAD ROSTER

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Nomad Child	0	Caravan-raised youth trained early in water discipline, animal care, and desert survival.
Nomad Commoner	0	Herdsfolk, tent-keepers, and traders forming the social backbone of the caravan.
Nomad Scout	1/8	Dune runner who reads wind and sand, detecting threats before they reach the caravan.
Nomad Camel Handler	1/4	Mounted logistics expert who controls caravan movement and emergency repositioning.
Nomad Caravan Guard	1/2	Shield-bearing defender who protects trade lines through disciplined formation fighting.
Nomad Desert Rider	1	Camel-mounted skirmisher who strikes, withdraws, and controls open desert space.
Nomad Trader	2	Negotiator and deal-maker whose influence often prevents violence before it begins.
Nomad Shield Captain	3	Defensive commander who strengthens shield formations and coordinates caravan defense.
Nomad Sand Cleric	4	Divine desert guide who shapes sand, protects caravans, and locates hidden water.
Nomad Caravan Master	5	Wealthy trade authority who commands multiple families and directs regional routes.
Nomad Dune Sovereign	6	Spiritual and political apex leader whose presence shapes both diplomacy and battlefield.



NOMAD CAMEL HANDLER

Medium humanoid (human), any alignment

Armor Class 14 (shield)

Hit Points 22 (4d8+4)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
12 (+1)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	11 (+0)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)

Skills Animal Handling +4, Survival +4, Perception +4

Senses passive Perception 14

Languages Common

Challenge 1/4 (50 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +2

Desert Born. This nomad has advantage on saving throws against exhaustion caused by extreme heat.

Water Discipline. This nomad requires only half the normal daily water intake to avoid dehydration in desert environments.

Camel Mastery. While mounted on a camel, this nomad has advantage on Wisdom (Animal Handling) checks and cannot be dismounted against its will unless it is incapacitated.

ACTIONS:

Spear. *Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft. or range 20/60 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d6+2) piercing damage.

BONUS ACTIONS:

Coordinated Mount. While mounted, this nomad can command its camel to take the Dash or Disengage action.

- Camel handlers manage the caravan's mobility. They are rarely the first to engage in combat and instead focus on repositioning animals, supplies, and noncombatants.
- If combat begins, this nomad attempts to mount quickly and reposition camels to block lines of approach or create difficult terrain for attackers.
- In encounters, camel handlers often serve as logistical NPCs: arranging pack animals, negotiating travel pace, or helping parties cross dangerous dunes.
- When threatened, this nomad fights defensively with shield and spear while attempting to disengage and reach a mounted position.
- Camel handlers are valuable guides across deserts and can quickly identify signs of dehydration, exhausted animals, or unsafe travel routes.



NOMAD TRADER

Medium humanoid (human), any alignment

Armor Class 15 (shield)

Hit Points 60 (8d8 + 24)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
12 (+1)	16 (+3)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)

Saving Throws Wis +4, Cha +5

Skills Insight +4, Persuasion +5, Deception +5, Perception +4

Senses passive Perception 14

Languages Common, one additional

Challenge 2 (450 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +2

Desert Born. This nomad has advantage on saving throws against exhaustion caused by extreme heat.

Water Discipline. This nomad requires only half the normal daily water intake to avoid dehydration in desert environments.

Silver Tongue. This nomad has advantage on Charisma (Persuasion) checks made to negotiate trade, ransom, or safe passage.

ACTIONS:

Multiattack. This nomad makes two Scimitar attacks.

Scimitar. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target.
Hit: 6 (1d6 + 3) slashing damage.

REACTIONS:

Shield Brace. When a creature this nomad can see hits it with a melee attack, this nomad adds +2 to its AC against that attack, potentially causing it to miss.

- This trader avoids combat whenever possible.
- It attempts negotiation before violence.
- It fights defensively while retreating toward guards.
- It values cargo and safe passage above pride.



NOMAD SAND CLERIC

Medium humanoid (human), any alignment

Armor Class 14 (shield)

Hit Points 95 (14d8 + 28)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	18 (+4)	14 (+2)

Saving Throws Wis +6, Con +4

Skills Insight +6, Medicine +6, Religion +3, Survival +5

Damage Resistances fire (while in desert sunlight)

Senses passive Perception 14

Languages Common

Challenge 4 (1,100 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +2

Desert Born. This nomad has advantage on saving throws against exhaustion caused by extreme heat.

Sand Stride. This nomad ignores difficult terrain caused by sand or loose earth.

Divine Guidance of the Hidden Well (1/Day). After 10 minutes of prayer in desert terrain, this nomad learns the direction and

distance to the nearest natural water source within 10 miles, if one exists. This feature fails in magically blighted terrain and does not detect magically created water.

Spellcasting. This nomad is a 7th-level spellcaster. Its spellcasting ability is Wisdom (spell save DC 14, +6 to hit with spell attacks). It requires no material components.

- **At will:** *guidance, sacred flame, thaumaturgy*
- **1st Level (3 Slots):** *create or destroy water, cure wounds*
- **2nd Level (3 Slots):** *lesser restoration, hold person*
- **3rd Level (3 Slots):** *spirit guardians*
- **4th Level (1 Slot):** *control water*

ACTIONS:

Multiattack. This nomad makes two Scimitar attacks.

Scimitar. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target.
Hit: 6 (1d6 + 2) slashing damage.

BONUS ACTIONS:

Sand Veil. Swirling sand fills a 10-ft.-radius area centered on this nomad until the start of its next turn. The area is lightly obscured for hostile creatures.

- This cleric prioritizes healing and battlefield control.
- It uses Sand Veil to obscure ranged attackers.
- It protects caravans and water sources above all.
- It retreats only if sacred wells are secure.



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